CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

CRM / EMAIL MARKETER IN THE AI ERA

AI can write the email. It can't decide who should get it, when, and why they'd care.

★ TL;DR — ~$75K median for the person who runs a brand's inbox — and the inbox quietly prints money. Training runs 6–12 months; the catch is you're judged on revenue numbers, not pretty copy. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

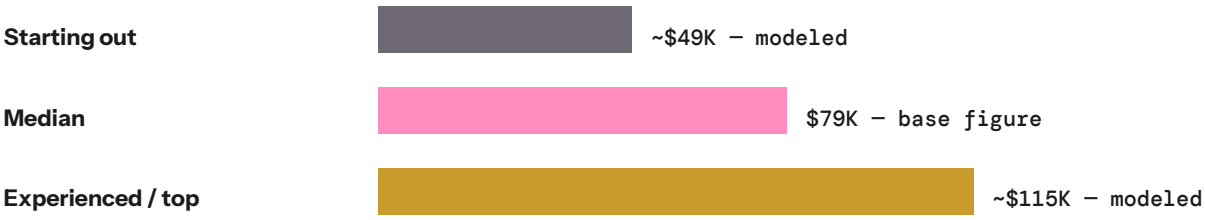
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$79K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK MEDIUM · CERTIFICATE

- Every online store needs retention revenue, and email is still where a huge share of it happens.
- The work is half writing, half data: segments, flows, tests, and reading what the numbers say.
- AI drafts copy fast — strategy, timing, and list judgment are what you're actually paid for.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for CRM / Email Marketer is a ~$79K median (compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A CRM / EMAIL MARKETER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Build automated flows: welcome series, abandoned cart, post-purchase, win-back
- ✓ Plan and send campaign emails on a calendar tied to launches and seasons
- ✓ Segment the list and run A/B tests on subject lines, offers, and send times
- ✓ Report on revenue per send and clean the list so emails actually land

Think: the bartender of a brand's customer list — you know the regulars, what they order, and when they've gone quiet.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI writes first drafts, subject-line variants, and product copy in seconds. It also builds basic flows from templates and summarizes campaign reports for you.	Deciding the strategy still takes a human: which segment gets which offer, when to push and when to back off. Brand voice, taste, and reading a customer's mood don't automate well.

⚠ **Agencies and brands churn through marketers who can't tie their work to revenue. If your emails don't make money, you're a cost line, not an asset.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Fully remote — a laptop and a list are the whole office ✓ Results are visible fast: send, measure, adjust ✓ Skills transfer to any industry that sells online	✗ Your worth is a dashboard, refreshed daily ✗ Promo calendars mean launches at ugly hours ✗ Inbox fatigue is real — you fight for attention all day

Good fit? You like writing AND spreadsheets, and you enjoy the game of figuring out why people click.
Bad fit? You want pure creative writing with no metrics, or numbers make your eyes glaze over.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — AGENCY	DOOR B — FREELANCE FIRST
Join an email or retention agency as a junior. You'll touch many brands fast, learn the platforms on real accounts, and build a portfolio of flows and results.	Pick up one small store, rebuild its welcome and cart flows, and use the before/after numbers as your portfolio. Slower start, but you keep the client relationship.

Smart move: Learn one major platform deeply instead of dabbling in five — hiring posts name platforms, not 'email marketing' in the abstract.
Where you land after: Senior lifecycle/retention lead, then head of CRM or retention director at a brand.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	MASTER ONE	GET THE	BUILD PROOF,	GET INSIDE	OWN THE

STEP 1 — Learn the craft basics

FREE · WEEKS 1-4

- Study lifecycle marketing: flows vs campaigns, segmentation, deliverability.
- Rewrite real brand emails every week to train your eye.

STEP 2 — Master one platform

FREE-$100 · MONTH 2

- Build a full demo account: welcome, cart, browse, win-back flows.
- Learn list hygiene: bounces, spam traps, sunsetting dead contacts.

STEP 3 — Get the certificate

$100-400 · MONTHS 2-4

- Complete a recognized email-marketing or platform certification.
- Add a digital marketing certificate if you have zero marketing background.

STEP 4 — Build proof, not a resume

FREE · MONTHS 3-6

- Do one real project — a small store, a nonprofit, a friend's shop.
- Document before/after: opens, clicks, revenue per send.

STEP 5 — Get inside a real account

PAID · MONTHS 5-9

- Apply to junior agency and in-house roles with your project numbers up front.
- Or land 1–2 freelance clients and run their full calendar.

STEP 6 — Own the calendar

WORKING · MONTHS 9-12

- Plan a quarter of campaigns and flows end to end.
- Present results in revenue terms — that's what renewals and raises are made of.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: pick the platform you'll master and create a free demo account.
- □ Days 1–30: finish the basics — flows, segments, deliverability — and rebuild one brand's welcome series as practice.
- □ Days 31–60: complete your demo flows and start the certification.
- □ Days 61–90: certification done or nearly; one real mini-project underway with a small brand.
- □ Day 90: you have a working demo account, a certificate in hand or in progress, and a real project to show.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **THE INBOX IS A CASH REGISTER.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.